

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Sally blogs about Vincent van Gogh.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have a favorite painter?
- Who is it? Where are they from?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe people I admire.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can describe the quality of an object or a person.





Let's Explore!

Who was Vincent van **Gogh***? What was his life like?

* In American English, "Gogh" is pronounced as *go*. In British English, it is pronounced as *goff*.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

You may have heard of Vincent van Gogh, one of the world's most famous artists. His paintings have become some of the most valuable and most desired among art buyers and dealers. Vincent Willem van Gogh's life was as colorful and unusual as his paintings. In his early career, he became a clergyman and a teacher. He moved to a coal-mining town in Belgium and was so moved by the impoverished life of the miners, that he began sleeping on the floor and giving away his belongings. He was a very empathetic person. He suffered from mental illness and depression for most of his later life. He also had a very unstable love life, which influenced the themes and images he chose in his art. He turned to painting as a way to express himself. Have you seen his paintings? What do you think of them? Have you ever used art as a way to express yourself?





Let's Practice!

Can you describe a famous artist?

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B. When you complete the sentences, read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. colorful
2. unusual
3. impoverished
4. empathetic
5. unstable

COLUMN B

- a. not normal; strange
- b. full of color; lively, interesting
- c. poor; having no money
- d. unpredictable; mentally ill
- e. able to understand another person's feelings



Let's Practice!

Who is the most famous* artist in your country?

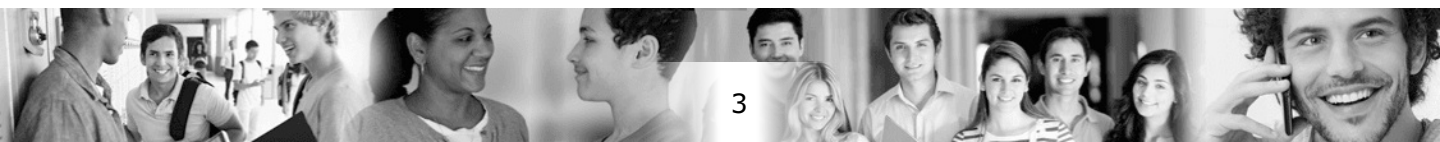
*Remember the rules of how to form the superlative form.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the words from the box to correctly complete the sentence.

Word bank

more famous / most famous / better / best / most desired
/ best desired / most valuable / prettiest / most pretty

1. Van Gogh is one of the world's _____ artists.
2. The Starry Night is considered to be his _____ painting.
3. Van Gogh's work is some of the _____ in the world.
4. Van Gogh's paintings are some of the _____ in the museums.
5. I think Irises is van Gogh's _____ painting.





Extension Activity

Choose a favorite!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find examples of three Vincent van Gogh paintings.
- Choose the one you like the best.
- Write a short paragraph describing the painting and why it is your favorite.
- Read your paragraph aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I look at three examples of van Gogh's art.

☐
☐

I decide which one I like the best.

☐
☐

I write a short paragraph describing the painting.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **colorful** (adjective): full of color; lively; interesting
e.g. Vincent van Gogh's life was as colorful as his paintings.
- **unusual** (adjective): not normal; strange
e.g. Vincent van Gogh's style was unusual.
- **impoverished** (adjective): poor; having no money
e.g. Van Gogh lived in an impoverished town.
- **empathetic** (adjective): able to understand another person's feelings
e.g. Van Gogh was a very empathetic person.
- **depression** (noun): a state in which a person feels hopeless and very sad
e.g. Van Gogh suffered from depression most of his life.
- **mental** (adjective): of the mind
Example: Van Gogh had a mental illness.
- **coal-mining** (noun): the act of taking coal from the ground to use as fuel
Example: Van Gogh moved to a coal-mining town.
- **dealer** (noun): a person who sells art to people
e.g. Van Gogh's art is valuable to art dealers.
- **buyer** (noun): a person who buys art
e.g. Buyers like to find van Gogh art.
- **unstable** (adjective): unpredictable; mentally ill
e.g. Van Gogh became more unstable later in life.





Learning Points

Superlatives

You use a superlative adjective to express the highest degree of a quality.

You use a superlative adjective to talk about one thing or person in a group of things. You always use *the* with the superlative.

Superlatives can be regular:

the + adjective-est

the most adjective

or irregular

Adjective	Superlative
good	the best
bad	the worst
fine	the finest
quiet	the quietest
pretty	the prettiest
lovely	the loveliest
valuable	the most valuable
intelligent	the most intelligent

Examples:

- *You may have heard of Vincent van Gogh, one of the world's **most famous** artists.*
- *His work is some of the **most desired** in the world.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You can use the Simple Past tense and the Present Perfect to talk about past events. However, there are important differences:

You use the **Simple Past** to talk about events that happened at a specific time in the past.

Examples:

*I **went** to the gallery last week.*

*Peter **bought** a painting at the gallery three years ago.*

You use the Present Perfect when you talk about past experiences, but the exact time of the event is either unknown or irrelevant.

Examples:

*I **have visited** many museums in the city.*

*We **have learned** a lot about painting and history.*

You can also use the Present Perfect to talk about an action that started in the past and continues in the present.

Examples:

*I **have studied** painting and history at university for two years.*

*The painting **has been** in the Louvre museum for 20 years.*